city of Berlin, offer a compelling case study for exploring her creative process, as well as her personal projects of healing and diasporic connection. As Lorde powerfully wrote, “Poetry is not only dream and vision; it is the skeleton architecture of our lives,” the divided city offered the author a poetic architecture of what Lester Olson terms “transnational sisterhood” and a creative space to continue working across lines of division despite her ambivalence.[15] Such a vision of “skeleton architecture” works in divided Berlin for Lorde, as she employs multiple forms of construction of and revision to her poems there to reimagine borders of Cold War geopolitics and to delve into matters of political complexity, personal estrangement, and survival.

The Cold War context for Lorde’s poetic self-exploration can be best understood through her mixed and flexible treatment of the Wall. She brings the Berlin Wall into reflection with other global sites of division and shifts her emphases based on the historical and geopolitical focus of her respective evocations. She engages with the division of Germany closely in *Our Dead Behind Us* and builds out additional reflections in complementary poetic writing, prose, journals, and open letters. This chapter reads her publicly circulating work, as animated with readings of revised poems, journal entries, and photographs and recordings from archives devoted to her oeuvre, to view how multiple layers of revision and editorial selection inform her geopolitical views: how, when, and if Lorde depicts the Berlin Wall in order to reflect on broader thematics and moments she encounters around her time in divided Berlin. Thus Lorde’s poetry can also be understood in conversation with broader discourses on memory and border politics, including those that contest the Reagan administration’s reaccelerated Cold War policies and other cultural actions envisioned or enacted by the Berlin Wall.

The Reagan White House’s call for Cold War peace in early 1984 immediately followed several proxy instigations directed at its Soviet Cold War antagonists, including the invasion of Grenada. Together, both forms of politicking served as mutual, if not befuddling, counterpoints of strategy to simultaneously enflame and pursue dialogue with the Soviet Union. In spite of the pendulum shifts in policy concurrent with multiple sites of proxy conflict around the world, Germany’s political status continued to inform the